

Using AI Tools to Prepare Official Statistical Reports

A Practical Learning Guide for NSO Nepal Staff

National Statistics Office of Nepal

June 2026

Step 1: The Right Mental Model

What is AI?

Think of AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, DeepSeek, Qwen) like a very well-read, fast-writing colleague.

What AI is EXCELLENT for:

- Drafting narrative paragraphs from data you provide.
- Rewriting awkward sentences into formal English.
- Generating report outlines and structures.

What AI is UNRELIABLE for:

- Quoting specific statistics not provided to it.
- AI can "hallucinate" (invent) plausible-sounding but incorrect numbers.

Step 2: Prompt Engineering (The RCTF Framework)

The quality of AI output depends entirely on your prompt.

Use the **RCTF Framework** for NSO reports:

Role	Tell AI who it is (<i>"You are an official report writer for NSO Nepal"</i>)
Context	Provide your data (<i>"Here is our CPI data for Q2 2024..."</i>)
Task	State exactly what you want (<i>"Write a press release narrative"</i>)
Format	Specify length, tone (<i>"Formal, 150 words, no bullet points"</i>)

Step 2: RCTF Framework in Action (Example)

Full Prompt Example for a CPI Bulletin

[R]ole: You are a senior economist drafting text for NSO Nepal's Consumer Price Index (CPI) bulletin.

[C]ontext: Data (FY 2023/24, Nepal):

- Overall CPI: 5.4% (year-on-year)
- Food and beverages: 6.1%
- Non-food and services: 4.9%

[T]ask: Write the opening paragraph for the monthly CPI press release. State the headline figure and compare food vs. non-food inflation.

[F]ormat: Use a formal, official tone appropriate for a government press release. Be no longer than 120 words. Do NOT fabricate any additional statistics.

Steps 3 & 4: Outlines and Data-to-Narrative

Structuring Reports

- Never start with a blank page.
- Ask AI to generate a complete section-by-section outline.
- Adjust the outline to match NSO house style.

Drafting Narratives

- 1 **Extract data** (Excel/SPSS).
- 2 **Paste data IN the prompt.**
- 3 **Specify highlights** (tell AI what trends matter).
- 4 **Request narrative** (RCTF).
- 5 **Verify every number.**

Drafting Summaries & Press Releases

- AI is excellent at translating complex statistical findings into clear language for policymakers and media.
- Always include a clear headline and key findings.

AI as an Editor

- Paste your draft and ask AI to improve clarity, formality, and consistency.
- *Example Prompt:* "Rewrite this in formal, official language without losing meaning. Do NOT change any statistics."

Step 7: Fact-Checking and Verification

Never Trust AI Blindly

AI can subtly introduce errors by rounding numbers, switching units, or confusing time periods.

The NSO Verification Checklist:

- ✓ Every number verified against the source table.
- ✓ Units are correct (% , percentage points, NRs, millions).
- ✓ Time periods match (e.g., FY 2023/24).
- ✓ Geographic scope is correct (national/urban/rural).
- ✓ No invented statistics not present in original data.

Step 8: Ethics, Privacy, and Responsible AI

The Golden Question

Before pasting any data into an AI tool, ask:

"Would I post this on our website?"

□ Safe to Paste

- Published aggregate statistics
- Your own draft text for editing
- Publicly available NSO reports

X NEVER Paste

- Individual/household microdata
- Embargoed pre-release data
- Internal HR or policy docs

Summary: The Five Golden Rules

- 1 You bring the data. AI brings the words.
- 2 Always verify every number in AI output.
- 3 Never paste confidential or unpublished data into AI.
- 4 Use the RCTF framework for every prompt.
- 5 AI is a tool. You are the expert.